WEB DEVELOPMENT • HTTP METHODS

GET vs. POST

A Simple Comparison of HTTP Methods

1. Introduction

HTTP is a protocol that allows web browsers and servers to communicate. GET and POST are two common HTTP methods, but they are used for different purposes.

2. What is GET?

The GET method is used to request or retrieve information from a server. For example, when you open a webpage, your browser may use GET. It is mainly used to read information.

3. What is POST?

The POST method is used to send data to a server. It is often used when a user submits a form, creates an account, or sends a message. The server can process or store this data.

4. Main Differences

Point	GET	POST
Main purpose	Retrieve data	Send data
Example	Opening a webpage	Submitting a form
Data location	Often in the URL	Usually in the request body
Common use	Reading information	Submitting information

Quick note: GET data may appear in the URL, while POST data is usually sent in the request body. POST is not automatically secure; HTTPS is important for protecting data in transit.

5. Conclusion

In conclusion, GET and POST are both important HTTP methods. GET is mainly used to retrieve data, while POST is mainly used to send data to a server. Choosing the correct method helps a website work as expected.